EDITION 1.0 · FACTS CHECKED 9 NOV 2026

THE CREATOR PLAYBOOK

How to make money from **Grand Theft Auto VI** content, with honest numbers and the rules that protect your income.



90-DAY PLAN INSIDE

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READ THIS FIRST

VIEWS ARE CHEAP. TRUST IS THE MONEY.

$0.02-0.05
GAMING SHORTS · PER 1,000 VIEWS
ESTIMATE

~$1.50-3.50
GAMING LONG-FORM · PER 1,000 VIEWS
ESTIMATE

~$4.30
YOU KEEP FROM ONE $4.99 GUIDE SALE
Payhip free plan, after fees

One million GTA Shorts views might earn **$20 to $50** in ad revenue. A hundred people buying a $4.99 guide earns about **$430**. That's the whole strategy in two sentences: **use Shorts for reach, long-form for ad revenue, and your own products for income.**

! **The disconfirming data.** Most creators earn little or nothing. GTA VI will be one of the most crowded niches on YouTube. Nothing here is an income promise.

¡ RPM figures are third-party estimates from creator-analytics firms. They vary widely by country, season and audience. Your own YouTube Studio numbers beat any estimate.

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PART ONE

THE MONEY MAP

Seven ways GTA VI creators get paid. Three of them work from your **first day**, before YouTube pays you a cent.

STREAM	AVAILABLE FROM	WHAT YOU KEEP	WHO CONTROLS IT
★ **Your own guides**	Day 1	~90%	You
Affiliate links	Day 1	Small %	Retailer
Services for creators	Day 1	100%	You
Fan funding (Super Thanks, memberships)	500 subs	Majority	YouTube
YouTube ad revenue	1,000 subs + hours/views	55% long · 45% Shorts	YouTube
Twitch subs and bits	Affiliate	Varies	Twitch
Sponsorships	Proven audience	100% of the fee	Brand

START HERE

Your own guides. Highest margin, and nobody can demonetize them.

BUILD TOWARD

YouTube Partner Program. Slow, but it compounds on evergreen guide videos.

LATER

Sponsors want proof. A steady view count and a clean channel come first.

The 55% / 45% ad-revenue split is from YouTube's Partner Program terms. "Services" means editing, thumbnails or voiceover for other GTA creators.

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PART TWO

GETTING MONETIZED

YOUTUBE TIER	REQUIREMENT	UNLOCKS
Lower tier	500 subscribers + 3 uploads in 90 days + either 3,000 watch hours in 12 months *or* 3M Shorts views in 90 days	Memberships, Super Thanks, Shopping
Full YPP (until 31 Jan 2027)	1,000 subscribers + either **4,000** watch hours in 12 months *or* **10M** Shorts views in 90 days	Ad revenue
Full YPP (from 1 Feb 2027)	1,000 subscribers + either **8,000** watch hours *or* **20M** Shorts views	Ad revenue

THE DEADLINE NOBODY'S TALKING ABOUT REPORTED

QUALIFY BEFORE 1 FEBRUARY 2027

YouTube reportedly doubles the entry bar for *new* applicants from that date, and existing partners keep their status. GTA VI's launch window falls neatly before it. Treat the next 12 weeks as your best shot at the lower bar.

WATCH-HOURS PATH

Long-form guides of 8 to 15 minutes. 4,000 hours is about 24,000 viewers watching 10 minutes each. Shorts watch time **doesn't count**.

SHORTS PATH

10M Shorts views in 90 days is roughly 111,000 a day. Possible in a launch window, hard afterwards. The two paths don't combine.

Only public videos count. Ad-campaign views don't count. Thresholds are as reported by vidIQ and AIR Media-Tech; check the Earn tab in YouTube Studio.

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PART THREE

RULES THAT PROTECT INCOME

ROCKSTAR'S VIDEO POLICY

01 **Allowed:**
Your own gameplay, Let's Plays, reviews, guides. Rockstar says it's happy for fans to upload gameplay.

02 **Removed:**
Pre-release or leaked footage, early unboxings, videos of the ending, and cutscenes uploaded on their own.

03 **Grey area:**
The policy is written for non-commercial fan use. For anything beyond normal ad revenue, email `copyright@take2games.com` first.

YOUTUBE'S GAMING-VIOLENCE RULES

REPORTED

0-7s	8-15s	15s+
Graphic violence = **no ads**	**Limited** ads	Broader eligibility

Open every video on a calm hook (a car, a view, your narration), not a shootout. Keep gore out of thumbnails and titles. Gaming drug-use content became eligible for ads in the same September 2026 update.

♪ **Radio = Content ID.** Licensed in-game music can send your revenue to the rights holder. Turn the radio off when recording.

✕ **No logos or key art** on thumbnails, products or channel art. Make your own.

! **Inauthentic content.** YouTube can remove mass-produced, repetitive channels from YPP. Faceless is fine; low-effort isn't.

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PART FOUR

WHAT TO MAKE, WHEN

PRE-LAUNCH NOW

Prep content. Storage, editions, pre-load times, confirmed vs rumour. High search interest, low competition from people with footage.

WEEK 1

First impressions and settings. "Best settings", "things I wish I knew", beginner tips. Fast Shorts plus one long video a day if you can.

WEEKS 2-6

Search-driven guides. Money methods, where to find things, side activities. These are the videos people search for and keep watching for months.

ONLINE TBA

Online mode. No date yet. When Rockstar announces it, a second launch window opens. Be first with a starter guide.

PC · RUMOUR 2027?

PC version. Unconfirmed, but if it lands it brings a third spike: settings, performance, and later mods (official channels only).

THE LONG TAIL

A guide that answers a real question ("how to make money fast in...") earns for months. A hot take earns for a day.

SPOILER DISCIPLINE

Label late-story videos in the title and thumbnail. Ending videos also risk removal under Rockstar's policy.

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PART FIVE

SELL YOUR OWN PRODUCTS

THE PRODUCT LADDER

01 **$5 starter guide**
A pre-launch or beginner guide. Gets your first buyers and your email list.

02 **$8 to $10 deep guide**
Money, collectibles, side activities. Built from real play, updated free.

03 **$15 bundle**
Everything, plus all future editions. Your best seller per hour of work.

04 **Services**
Thumbnails, edits, voiceover for other GTA channels. Trades time for money, but it pays now.

ADS VS ONE PRODUCT

1M Shorts views (ads)	$20-50
100 guide sales at $4.99	~$430
1,000 guide sales at $4.99	~$4,300

Payhip free plan: 5% + about 2.9% + $0.30 payment processing.

! **Never sell Rockstar's work.** No game art, no traced official maps, no ripped audio or screenshots in paid products. Your words, your diagrams, your designs.

WHERE TO PUT THE LINK

Pinned comment · first line of every description · channel "Links" section · end screen of long videos · one line spoken in the video ("the full checklist is in the guide, linked below").

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PART SIX

SPONSORS & AFFILIATES

NATURAL FITS FOR GTA

Storage drives (212 GB is a real problem), controllers, headsets, capture cards and gaming chairs. Recommend what you'd actually use.

AFFILIATE LINKS

Retailer programmes pay a small percentage of each sale. Small money, but it starts on day one and suits "best gear" videos.

PITCHING A BRAND

Send your average views per video over the last 30 days, audience countries and age, and two example videos. Ask for their budget before you name a price.

TWITCH REPORTED

Affiliate bar lowered in June 2026: **25 followers, 4 hours, 4 days, 3 average viewers** within 30 days. Twitch reportedly opened sponsorships to Affiliates in Aug 2026.

Disclose every paid deal. Tick YouTube's "includes paid promotion" box *and* say it out loud in the video. US FTC rules require clear disclosure of sponsorships and affiliate links, and other countries have similar rules.

× **Say no to:** gambling or "skins" sites, "free GTA" or "mod menu" offers, account-boosting, and anything promising money for nothing. They burn audience trust and can get your channel struck.

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PART SEVEN

THE FACELESS CREATOR STACK

CAPTURE

Start with the console's built-in capture. **PS5:** Settings › Captures and Broadcasts. **Xbox:** Settings › Preferences › Capture & share. Add a capture card later for longer recordings.

VOICE

Your own voice builds the most trust. A clean mic and a quiet room beat an expensive setup. If you use an AI voice, add real insight on top.

EDIT

Captions on every Short. A cut every 2 to 3 seconds in Shorts. Chapters in long videos, so people can jump straight to the answer.

WHAT MAKES FACELESS WORK

01 **One promise per video**
"The fastest money in the first hour, tested" beats "GTA VI tips #14".

02 **Proof on screen**
Show the money counter, the map location, the setting. Viewers trust what they see.

03 **Original value**
Your testing, your route, your verdict. That's what separates you from re-uploads and keeps you in YPP.

04 **Consistent look**
Same thumbnail layout, colours and type, so returning viewers spot you instantly.

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PART EIGHT

YOUR FIRST 90 DAYS

WEEKS 1–2

LAUNCH SPRINT

1 long video + 2 Shorts a day. Starter guide live. Link in every description.

WEEKS 3–4

FIND WHAT WORKS

Check Studio: which videos hold viewers? Make three more like the best one.

WEEKS 5–8

BUILD THE LIBRARY

Search-driven guides. Release the $8 to $10 deep guide. Start an email list.

WEEKS 9–12

COMPOUND

Bundle offer. Apply for lower-tier YPP when eligible. First brand pitches with real numbers.

TRACK THESE FOUR NUMBERS WEEKLY

AVD	CTR	SUBS	SALES
AVG VIEW DURATION	THUMBNAIL CLICK RATE	PER 1,000 VIEWS	PER 1,000 VIEWS

$ **Money admin.** Creator income is taxable. Keep a simple spreadsheet of every payment and expense, and set aside a share of each payout for tax. Speak to an accountant once it's real money.

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SOURCES · CHECKED 9 NOVEMBER 2026

WHERE THE NUMBERS COME FROM

YouTube Partner Program: requirements and the reported Feb 2027 change, via vidIQ, AIR Media-Tech and PPC Land. Revenue shares are from YouTube's YPP terms.
RPM estimates: AIR Media-Tech (274-channel dataset) and creator-analytics blogs. These are estimates, not guarantees.
Rockstar video policy: Rockstar Support, "Policy on posting copyrighted Rockstar Games material" (last updated 10 Jan 2025).
YouTube gaming-violence update (Sept 2026): as reported by Dexerto, Outlook Respawn and Northeast Times.
Twitch Affiliate: thresholds as reported by creator guides citing Twitch's Help Center (Oct 2026).
Storefront fees: platform comparisons by Sellfy and others. Check each platform's pricing page.

! **Educational only. Not financial or legal advice.** No income is promised or implied. Platform rules change. Check the official pages before you act.

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